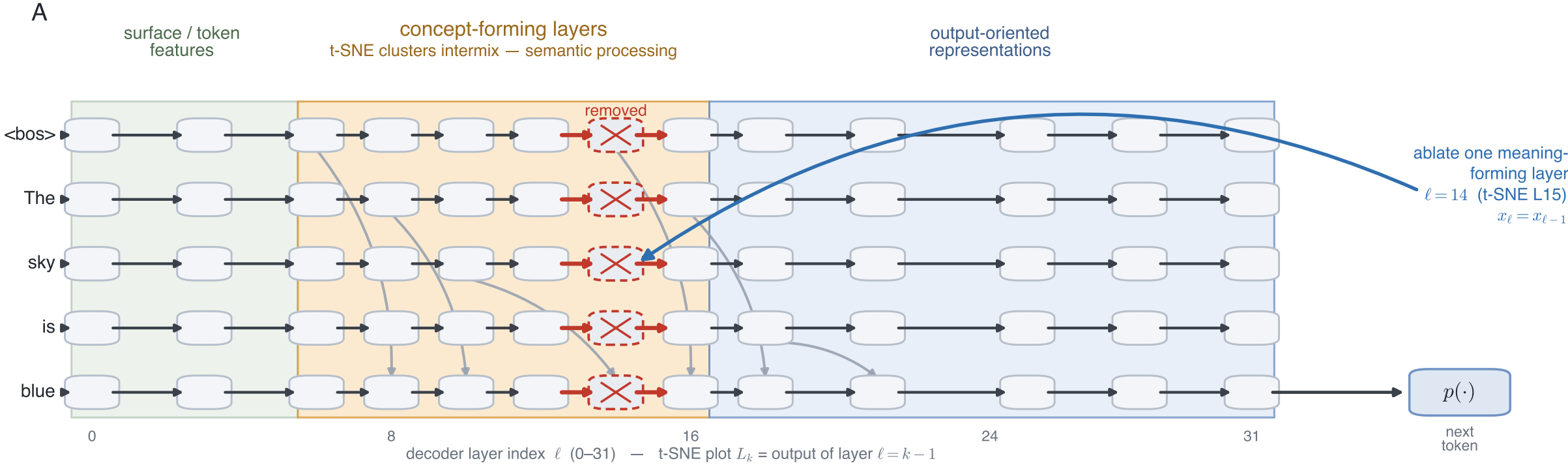
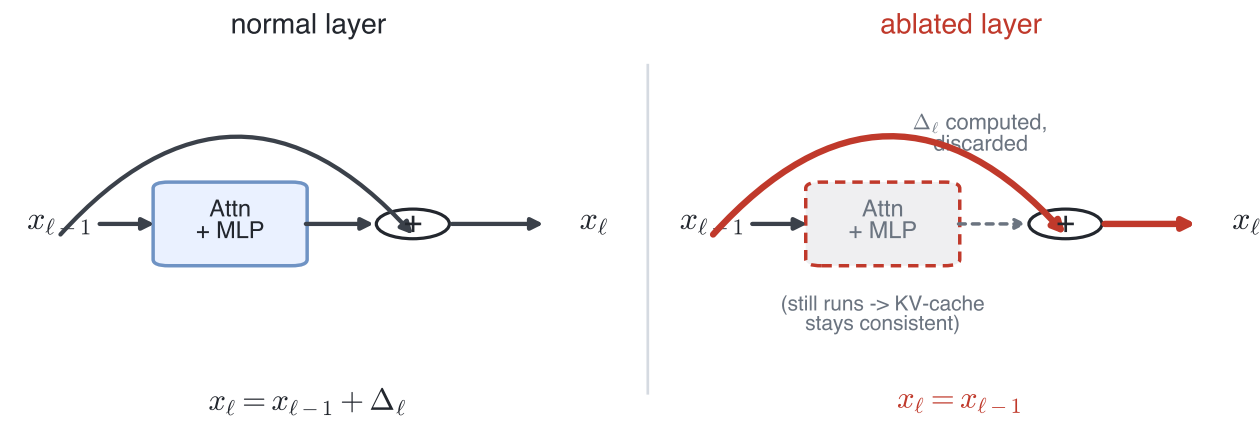


Removing a meaning-forming layer from Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct

Ablate one middle decoder layer (residual stream passes straight through), regenerate, and measure the shift.

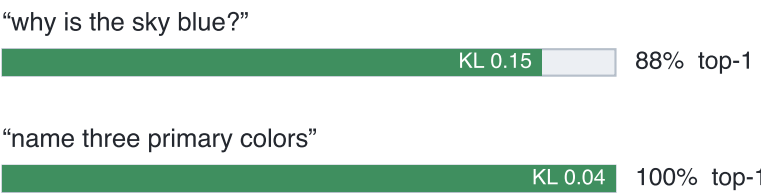


B Ablation mechanism: discard-delta wrapper



C Measured effect on generation

Ablating $\ell = 14$ (t-SNE L15) · Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct, 4-bit on a T4



Output stays coherent and on-topic — a single middle layer is individually robust (the residual stream routes around it). Early / late layers break generation instead.